

Getting Past the Gatekeeper

One Wealth Map RIA outreach

Each situation shows the goal and the reason behind it. Say it in a way that feels natural to you.

Know your goal

With a gatekeeper: **get connected**. With the owner: **book the meeting**.

Leave with something

Try to end each call with a **transfer**, a **callback time**, a **direct line**, or an **email**.

Keep it short

Your answer to a gatekeeper should be one or two sentences. Long answers sound like a sales call.

START HERE Think of the gatekeeper as a building guard

A guard lets people in when they give a name and a clear reason. When someone starts explaining products, the guard usually stops them at the lobby. Gatekeepers work the same way.

A simple pattern to follow:



Why end with a question: asking "Are they available now?" keeps the call moving toward your goal. It gives the gatekeeper something simple to answer.

WORDS Words that help, words to avoid

These help

- **"Business matter"** is clear and true
- **"On behalf of our founder"** explains who the call is from
- **The owner's first name** shows you did your research
- **"Please"** and **"thank you"** keep it respectful
- **"Is a better time later today?"** gives you a next step

Avoid these

- **"Opportunity"** or **"potential"** sound like a sales call
- **"Offer," "services," "AI," "grow faster"** also sound like a sales call
- **A long company description** (location, type of firm) when they didn't ask
- **"Sorry to bother you"** at the start makes the call sound unimportant
- **Trailing off** mid-sentence makes it harder to finish your point

Always be honest

Be confident, but **only say what's true**. Don't say it's a follow-up call if it isn't. Don't say the owner or founder asked for the call unless that's confirmed. Don't pretend to know the owner. These calls can be recorded, and the firms we call are regulated. Honesty protects you, the client and One Wealth Map.

Playbook v2 reminders

Before you dial: check GHL and the lead source. Know if it's a firm owner or an individual advisor, and their first name.

Never say to a gatekeeper: anything about selling, buying, merging or recruiting, any numbers, or who else we're talking to. Owner conversations are confidential.

A Screening questions

The gatekeeper is checking who you are and why you're calling.

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
1	"What's this regarding?"	One short, true reason. Then ask for the owner again.	Like telling a guard "I'm here to see Mr. Reyes." You don't show them your presentation. Short answers sound clear and professional.
2	"Is this a sales call?"	Answer honestly, give the real reason, then redirect.	Like a guard asking "Delivery?" "No" alone can sound unclear. "No, it's a business matter" sounds like a visitor.
3	"Where are you calling from?"	Say the company name only. Add more only if they ask more.	Like a name tag. It says who you are. Nobody reads a brochure at the front desk.
4	"Do you have an appointment?"	Say no honestly, then redirect to availability.	Like walking up without a reservation. Restaurants still seat you if you ask confidently: "No reservation, is a table free now?"
5	"Does the owner know you?"	Be honest and stay confident.	Like a new neighbor knocking. You don't pretend to be a relative. Being honest keeps their trust.
6	"How did you get this number?"	Give the real source. Confirm the wording with your POC.	Like a shop asked how it got your address. A clear answer calms people. Avoiding the question can feel suspicious.
7	"Can I tell them what it's about?"	Enough to be passed along. Keep details for the owner.	Like a sealed letter. The secretary delivers it but doesn't open it. "Business matter" says important and private.
8	They keep asking for more details.	Stay short without sounding secretive.	Like a movie trailer. Enough to show it's worth it. The full story is for the owner.

B Owner not available

When the owner is busy, find out the best time to call back.

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
9	"They're with a client / in a meeting."	Get a specific callback time. Log it in GHL.	Like a doctor in surgery. You ask the nurse what time they'll be out. "Later" isn't a time.
10	"They're out this week."	Find the day they're back.	Like a store closed for the holidays. You check the reopening date instead of guessing.
11	"They're busy all day, every day."	Find a gap: early or late.	Like catching a busy professor. Not during class. Before the first or after the last.
12	"Everything goes through me."	Make the gatekeeper your partner.	Like a barangay hall. Follow their process and the secretary helps you. Fight it, and nothing moves.

C Brush-offs

Say yes to their request, then ask for one more detail.

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
13	"If they're interested, they'll call you back."	Ask for the best time to call instead.	Like "we'll text you" after a job interview. You may not hear back. Setting the next step yourself helps.
14	"Send an email."	Say yes, then ask for a direct email or a time.	Like "leave it at the front desk." It may sit in a pile. A direct address gives it a real chance.
15	"Send it to info@."	Avoid the general inbox.	Like a box marked "General." It might never get opened.
16	"Leave a message."	Leave it short, and set your own follow-up.	Like ordering food and waiting forever. Follow up yourself, or it may never come.
17	"Just leave a voicemail."	Use the playbook voicemail. Under 20 seconds.	Like a text vs. a long letter. People finish short messages. Say your number slowly, twice.
18	"We get calls like this all the time."	Show respect. Keep the ask tiny.	Like asking a busy cashier for one quick thing. "Two minutes" is easy to say yes to.

D When the gatekeeper decides

Stay polite and let the owner make the decision.

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
19	"They're not interested." (for the owner)	Let the owner decide. Ask to send one short note.	Like a helper saying "Ma'am doesn't want it." Ma'am never saw it.
20	"I handle these decisions."	Find out kindly if they're an owner or staff.	Like a barangay captain's secretary. They schedule, but only the captain signs.
21	"We already have an advisor." / "We don't need services."	Clear up the confusion.	Like a tutor turned away because "the kids have a teacher." You're there for the school owner, not the kids.
22	"We're not hiring." / "We're not selling."	Stay calm. Don't explain. Ask for the right person.	Like a family selling their house. They don't tell the helpers first. Owner plans can be private, even from staff.
23	"Talk to our operations manager."	Be polite. See if they can help you reach the owner.	Like being sent to a different window. They may not decide, but they may walk you to the right door.

E Rules and restrictions

Follow their rules, then ask for another way to reach the owner.

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
24	"No unsolicited calls. Remove us."	Exit politely. Mark Do Not Call in GHL.	Like a "No Solicitors" sign. Respecting it protects the company's reputation.
25	"Calls are recorded. They can't discuss this here."	Respect it. Ask for an email or a better number.	Like a bank full of CCTV. You don't argue with the rules. You ask to talk somewhere better.
26	"Compliance has to approve this."	Learn their process.	Like getting a permit. Go to the right window and things move faster.
27	"Our broker-dealer doesn't allow these calls."	Stay respectful. Never comment on their agreements.	Like someone's work contract. You're not their lawyer. That's for the principals.

F Phone systems and wrong contacts

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
28	Phone menu (IVR)	Reach a real person. Directory first, then "new clients."	Like a mall directory. Look up the store instead of walking every floor. Note what worked in GHL.
29	"No one here by that name."	Ask who owns the firm now. Update GHL.	Like an old address on a package. Fix it, or the next delivery fails too.

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
30	"They retired / left the firm."	Find the new owner. Update GHL.	Like a restaurant with a new owner. New leadership often means new plans.
31	"They passed away."	Offer condolences and end the call. Note it in GHL.	Like visiting during a wake. You show respect and leave. Never pitch.

G Other situations

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
32	A chatty, friendly gatekeeper	Build rapport. Learn the owner's schedule.	Like the friendly tita at the sari-sari store who tells you when the owner drops by.
33	A rude gatekeeper, or they hang up	Stay professional. Try another day.	Like a grumpy jeepney driver. Their bad day, not yours.
34	"Can you hold?" (long hold)	Keep the call. Get ready while waiting.	Like a bank line. Fill out your form while waiting so you're ready when called.
35	Third callback, same gatekeeper	Use their name. Mention the last call.	Like the guard who now greets you by name. Being polite and consistent builds familiarity.
36	You get cut off mid-sentence	Finish your point calmly, then redirect.	Like a jeepney stopping short of your stop. You still say "para po" and get off where you need to.
37	The owner answers directly	Switch to owner mode right away.	Like the boss walking past you in the lobby. Don't freeze. Greet them and introduce yourself.

H When you reach the owner

If the owner is still on the line, you still have a chance to ask a question.



#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
38	"I'm good." / "We're doing well."	Acknowledge with real energy. Then ask one question about what's next.	Like a healthy person and insurance. Doing well today is a good time to think about later.
39	"I'm busy."	Respect it. Ask for a few minutes now, or set a time.	Like an elevator ride. You get one floor's worth of time. Keep it brief and get to the point.
40	"Just send me information."	Treat it as a semi-win. Try one question first, then send.	Like flyers in your own inbox. Not all of them get read. Sometimes "send info" is a polite way to end the call.
41	"Not interested" right after your intro	Ask what they mean, or ask one future question.	Like rejecting a package before opening it. They may not know yet what the call is about.
42	"What is this about?" from the owner	Clear purpose in one line, then a question.	Like a doctor explaining before an exam. People relax when they know why you're there.
43	"Never heard of you." / "You're small."	Agree, then build up the founder with approved facts.	Like a new restaurant by an experienced chef. People try it because of the chef's background.
44	They say yes but "I'll book it later."	Offer two specific times now.	Like "let's hang out sometime." Without a date, it is easy to forget.

Remember

Acknowledge first. Say it warmly so it sounds sincere. **End with a question**, so the conversation keeps going.

PRACTICE**Write your own lines**

Write how you would say each one. Then practice saying them out loud.

Moment	My words
My opening to a gatekeeper	
	"What's this regarding?"
	"Is this a sales call?"
	"They're not available."
Owner: "I'm good."	
My ask for the meeting	

CHECKLIST**Before you hang up**

- ☐ Did I use first names?
- ☐ Was my reason one sentence?
- ☐ Did I avoid "opportunity" and pitch words?
- ☐ Did I end with a question?

- ☐ Did everything I say stay true?
- ☐ Did I leave with a time, line or email?
- ☐ Did I say please and thank you?
- ☐ Did I log it in GHL?